

Ilayda Mellissa Karadag

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Education

University of Oxford – (2018-present)

DPhil in Materials Science. Expected submission Early 2023.

“Characterisation of Native Tissue and Development of Multiphasic Scaffolds for Engineering of Bone-Ligament Interface”.

University of Exeter - (2014-2018)

MEng Materials Engineering. Achieved a First-class degree.

Highlands School – (2007-2014)

A-levels: A*- Mathematics

A - Physics

B - Further Mathematics, Chemistry, Turkish

GCSCs: 5A*, 6A, 2B

Academic award

- University of Exeter Bertie Black Prize 2017- In recognition of outstanding academic achievement in Engineering, out of all 2nd year Engineering Students at the University of Exeter 2016/7.
- Best SYIS Poster Presentation Award at the Tissue Engineering and Regenerative Medicine International Society- Asia-Pacific Conference 2022.

Conferences

Presented at the Tissue Engineering and Regenerative Medicine International Society- Asia-Pacific Conference 2022

Publications

- Asimeng, B.O., Karadag, I., Iftekhhar, S. *et al.* XRD and IR revelation of a unique g-C₃N₄ phase with effects on collagen/hydroxyapatite bone scaffold pore geometry and stiffness. *SN Appl. Sci.* **2**, 1417 (2020).
- Tabish TA, Pranjal MZI, Karadag I, Horsell DW, Whatmore JL, Zhang S. Influence of luminescent graphene quantum dots on trypsin activity. *Int J Nanomedicine*. **13**, 1525-1538 (2018)

Experience

University of Oxford Materials Department - (November 2018 – Present)

Materials Department Ambassador (2018-Present)

Project Lead in the Making Materials Matter Outreach Scheme (2018-2020)

- Supported recruitment and helped design and carry out outreach efforts.
- Delivered STEM workshops and presentations to a range of age groups and backgrounds.
- Led 2 groups of 15-20 year 8 pupils in projects aimed at inspiring the next generation of materials scientists and engineers.

St Catherine's College Boat Club (2019- Present)

Secretary (2021-present)

Assistant Coach (2021-present)

Club safety/COVID officer (2020-present)

President (2020-2021)

Women's Co-Captain (2019-2020)

- Coached novice rowers, and selected team to compete in intercollegiate races. Increased the number of rowers who transitioned to the senior squad.
- Innovated a new training regime for women's squad with head coach.
- Managed athlete safety and welfare post lock down.

- Liaised with college the safe return to rowing post lock down, allowing us to be the first club to be permitted to return.
- Organised, delivered, and secured funding for the first in-person training camp post lock-down amongst all Oxford collegiate clubs.
- Maintained high standards of COVID safety, resulting in minimal further disruptions to club activities and getting 40+ rowers race ready in under 8 weeks.
- Awarded the Ben Sylvester award for significant contribution to enhancing the rowing life of St Catherine's College, Oxford (2021).

Biomaterials Research Lab (2018-Present)

Safety Officer

- Conducted training to all new members in safety measures and accident prevention.
- Monitored compliance to lab policies and ensured all forms and records are up to standard.
- Arranged for the safe disposal of chemical and biological waste.
- Spearheaded research groups' return to onsite working post lockdown.

Oxford Materials Society (2021-2022)

Secretary

- Brought onboard to analyse and improve Executive Committee operations post lockdown.
- Brought about the registration of the society with the university.
- Made fundamental changes to society constitution which improved members experiences.
- Chaired committee meetings and liaised with department for society events.

OxHOS Roadshow 2019

- Volunteered for the Oxford Hands-On Science (OxHOS) society on the Essex leg of their summer roadshow, bringing science concepts and experiments to primary and secondary school students.
- Created and delivered suitable workshops to demonstrate physics concepts to various age groups.

University of Exeter (January 2016 – 2018)

Student Ambassador

- Worked as a University Representative; working as part of various teams to deliver recruitment and outreach events.
- Led outreach efforts to bring STEM subjects to girls aged 11-18.
- Delivered lectures/classes on Engineering to International summer school students aged 9-17.

University of Exeter Steel Band (2016– 2018)

Treasurer (2017-2018)

- Helped teach fellow members to play the steel pans.
- Prepared music arrangements for band.
- Managed club budget and trusted to handle all financial transactions.

Skills

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- Strong verbal, written, and interpersonal skills.
 - Diligent with an analytical mind.
 - Good knowledge of data analysis and risk assessment.
 - Languages: Turkish (Fluent).
 - Ballet RAD grade 8.
 - Tap RAD grade 8.

Interests

- Running- two-time marathon runner and numerous halves.
- Rowing- as an athlete and a coach.
- All forms of the arts.